

Understanding Delaware PFML Wages

If you've filed a Delaware Paid Family & Medical Leave (PFML) wage report, you've probably seen two reporting fields that raise questions: **DE FICA Wages** and **Combined Out-of-State Wages**. This article explains what those fields mean, why Delaware asks employers to report them, and how accurate reporting helps avoid common filing mistakes.

Understanding DE FICA Wages

DE FICA Wages are wages subject to Federal Insurance Contributions Act (FICA) taxes that are reported for Delaware PFML purposes. For most employers, these values already exist within the payroll system and generally align with Social Security and Medicare wage calculations.

Generally Included

- Regular wages and salaries
- Overtime
- Bonuses
- Commissions
- Reported tips
- Taxable fringe benefits

Generally Not Included

- Employer-paid health insurance
- Qualified retirement plan contributions
- Certain pre-tax cafeteria plan deductions
- Workers' compensation benefits
- Other non-taxable payments

Understanding Combined Out-of-State Wages

Combined Out-of-State Wages generally represent wages earned outside Delaware that are reported separately for Delaware PFML reporting. They are not the same as DE FICA Wages and serve a different reporting purpose.

Why Delaware Collects Both

The Healthy Delaware Families Act established Delaware's Paid Family & Medical Leave Program. To administer the program accurately, employers report specific wage information rather than simply reporting gross payroll.

Common Reporting Mistakes

- Reporting gross wages instead of DE FICA Wages.
- Leaving Combined Out-of-State Wages blank when employees worked outside Delaware.
- Using inconsistent payroll reports.
- Waiting until quarter-end to identify payroll issues.

Tips for Employers

- Verify payroll reports before filing.
- Understand which payroll fields Delaware is requesting.
- Review reports before submission.
- Address discrepancies promptly.

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